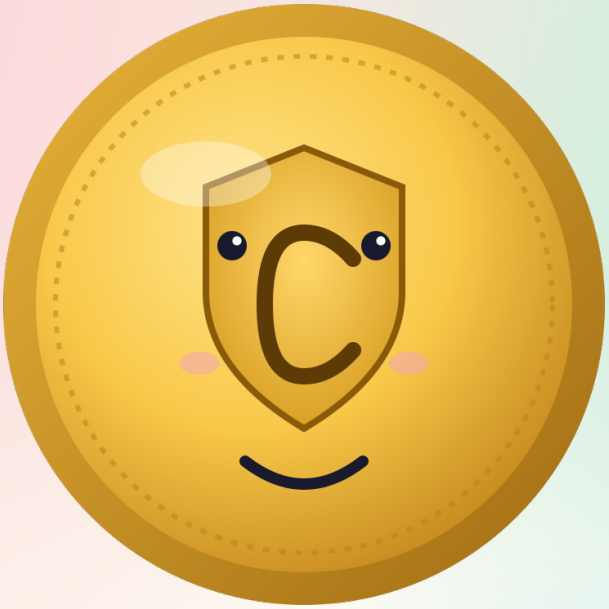


GRADE K

Parent Guide

C A S H

Businesses help people.

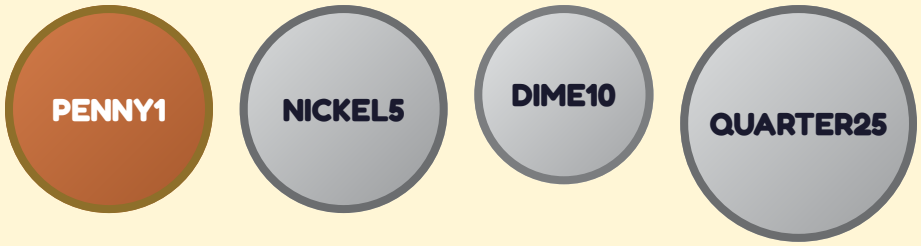
One good question per quarter, family-friendly.

Grade K — Cash to Company: Parent and Caregiver Guide

A short, warm guide for the adult who lives with a Grade K Cash to Company student.

What this year is

This year, your kindergartner is learning to **notice helpers**. The mail carrier is a helper. The librarian is a helper. The cook at school is a helper. So is the dentist, and so is the bus driver. Helpers do jobs. Helpers are a kind of business. That is the whole big idea of the year.



We also teach four coins — penny, nickel, dime, quarter — and which one is worth more in a pair. We teach putting three pictures in order (first, next, last). And we teach taking turns at "Cash's Cafe" — a pretend store the children run together at the end of the year.

That is it. We do not teach money in any complicated way. We do not teach pricing or profit. Those come later. This year is gentle. It is mostly play.

What your child is bringing home

You may see:

- A **drawing of a helper** — color the helper, talk about who they are.
- A **page of coins** — point and name. Penny. Nickel. Dime. Quarter.
- A **3-picture sequence** — what comes first? What's next? What's last?
- An invitation to a **Family Visit Day** at the end of the year. Cash's Cafe will be open. Your child will tell you about a helper they noticed.

Your child may say things like "that is a helper" or "please may I have a pretzel" or "the dime is small but it is more than the nickel." These are the year's wins.

CASH SAYS

Which coin is more? Show me with your hands.

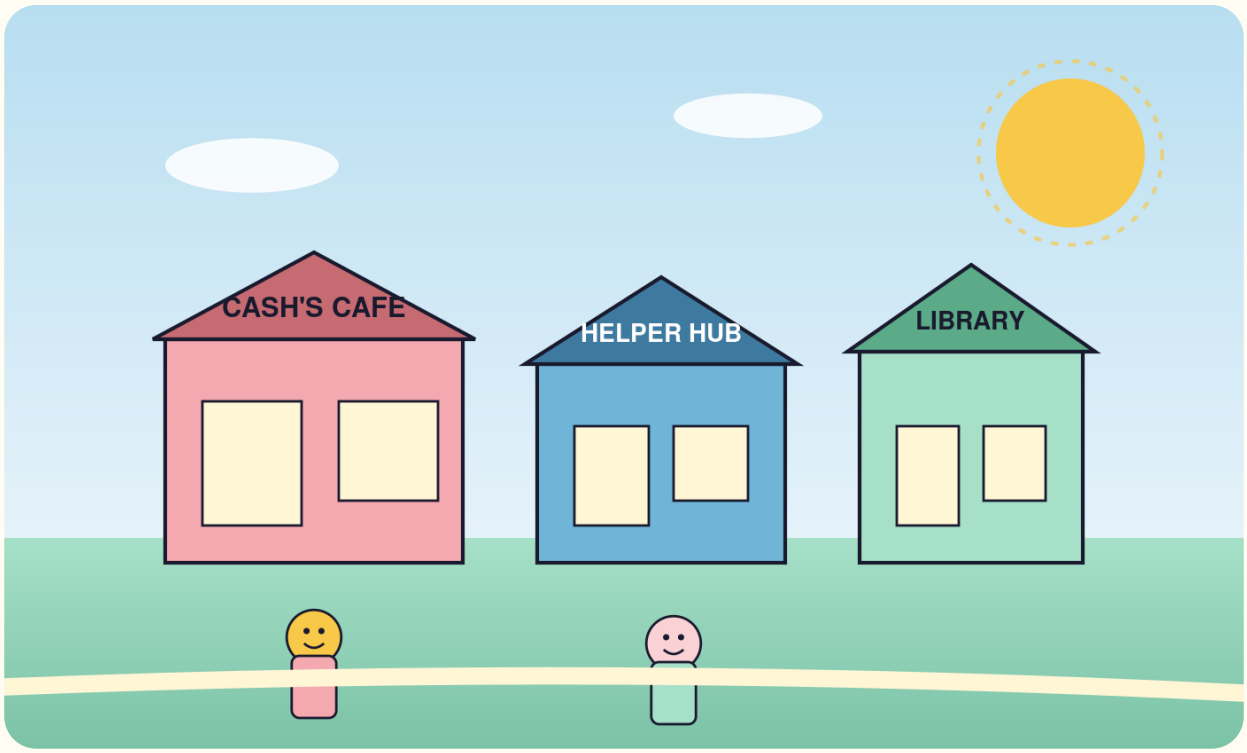
What you don't need to do

- **You don't need to teach anything.** A parent with no business background can fully support this year.
- **You don't need to buy anything.** No tools, no books, no supplies are required at home.

- **You don't need to share family financial details.** The curriculum will never ask your child about how much money your family has, what you do for work, or how much things cost in your home. If your child asks you a money question that feels invasive, you can say "that's a grown-up question" and that is a fine answer.

What you can do (if you want)

These are optional and low-effort. None of them are required.



Helpers are everywhere. Each one is a kind of business.

1. Ask one good question on a car ride or at dinner

Try one of these. Listen more than you speak.

- **September–October (Unit 1, Helpers):** "Who helped you today?" Or: "Who is a helper in our family?" Or: "Who is a helper down the street?"
- **November–January (Unit 2, Coins):** "Can you show me a penny? A dime? Which one is worth more?"
- **February–April (Unit 3, In Order):** "What did you do first this morning? What was next? What was last?" Or: "What's a safety rule the firefighter follows? Why?"
- **May–June (Unit 4, Cash's Cafe):** "At your cafe, what did you say to your customer? What kind words did you use?"

You don't need to know the answers. You're modeling curiosity. Your child will tell you.

2. Notice helpers together when you're out

When you're at the grocery store, the post office, the dentist, or the library — point and say, "that's a helper. They [what they do]." Your child has been doing this all year. They will join in.

3. Use the kind words at home

The year's three kind words are please, thank you, and you're welcome. If you make them part of your family's everyday talk, your child will hear the school version and the home version line up. They'll feel proud.

4. Read a picture book together

Any picture book about a community helper works. The school library has favorites — Last Stop on Market Street, A Chair for My Mother, Officer Buckle and Gloria. Read slowly. Pause. Ask, "who's a helper in this story?"

5. Come to Family Visit Day

Late in the year, the class hosts a Family Visit Day. Your child will show you the Helpers Wall and walk you to Cash's Cafe. If you can't come, the school will pair your child with another grown-up. But if you can come — please do.

CASH SAYS

What comes first? What comes next?

What to watch for

- **Your child starts pointing at helpers in real life.** This is the year working.
- **Your child names coins by sight.** They might mix up the dime and the nickel for a while; that's normal. The dime is small but worth more, which surprises every five-year-old.
- **Your child uses kind words a little more often.** Even if it's only at school, that's a real win.
- **Your child wants to play "shopkeeper" at home.** Encourage. A pretend store at the kitchen counter, with cardboard "money" and

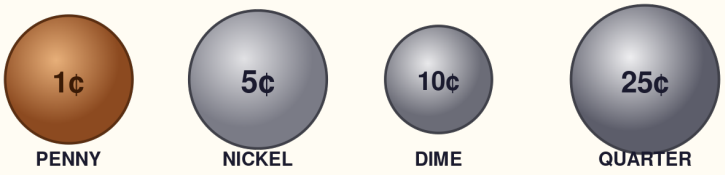
pretend snacks, is exactly the work this year is doing. Take a turn as the customer. Use kind words.

A few honest notes

- **Five is a wiggly age.** Some lessons land; some don't. By June, the noticing habit is what we want — not perfect coin recognition.
- **This curriculum doesn't promise wealth.** We teach clarity, not wealth. We say helpers help, and we noticed them.
- **If something feels wrong for your family,** tell the teacher. Skip the page. Use a different helper.

CASH SAYS

Tell me what they said with their words.



Penny. Nickel. Dime. Quarter. We say each name out loud.

A short message from Cash

"Hi, family. I'm Cash. Your kid noticed helpers all year. They learned the four coins. They took turns at our pretend cafe. Thank you for letting me hang out with them. Notice, notice, notice — that's all I ever ask. See you next year."

If you have questions, your child's teacher is the right person to ask. They have the year's plans, the assessment notes, and the day-to-day picture. They are also a helper. Notice them.

Senior expert upgrade pack — 30-second drive-time scripts

These are drop-in scripts for parents who want to support the year without doing any teaching. Each takes 30 seconds. None require parent expertise.

Script 1 — At the grocery store

You: "Look — that person at the register is a helper. What do they do?"
Child: (answers) You: "Yes. They help people pay for food."

That's it. Walk on. The child's noticing muscle just got stronger.

Script 2 — In the car

You: "On the way to school, count three helpers you see. Tell me at the next red light." Child: (counts: bus driver, crossing guard, parent walking a kid) You: "Three. Good noticing."

Script 3 — On the sidewalk

You: "Point to a sign that tells you what a place is." Child: (points: the pizza place, the bakery, the dentist) You: "How did you know? Because the sign told you."

Script 4 — At dinner (Unit 2 — coins)

Empty four real coins from your pocket onto the table. Ask: "Which coin is more?" Whatever your child answers, listen. If they're wrong, don't correct — just say "hmm, count the dots on the chart at school tomorrow." The teacher will sort it. You've offered the question and that's enough.

Script 5 — Walking the dog

You: "What's a job a helper does for animals?" Child: (answers: vet, dog walker, groomer) You: "Yes. All helpers."

Script 6 — Bedtime

You: "Who's a helper you noticed today?" Child: (answers)

End the day on a noticing question. The brain consolidates what you ask about. Next year your child will sort helpers into "makes a thing" or "does a thing" — bedtime questions like this are how that gets ready.

CASH SAYS

Notice, notice, notice. What did you see?

ROUND 2 PATCH — Three 30-Second Conversation Starters per Quarter (Kindergarten)

These take 30 seconds. They require no expertise. Pick one if a moment opens up.

Quarter 1 (Helpers in Our Community)

1. In the grocery checkout line: "Whos a helper here?" — Sample answer: "The cashier!" — Follow-up: "What do they help with?"
2. In the car, passing a fire station: "Who do firefighters help?" — Sample answer: "People in fires." — Follow-up: "Could a kid be a helper too? How?"
3. At dinner: "Did you see a helper today at school?" — Sample answer: "The lunch helper." — Follow-up: "What did they do?"

Quarter 2 (Coins and Counting)

1. Holding a handful of coins: "Whats this one called?" — point to a penny — "And this?" — to a dime. — Follow-up: "Which is worth more?"

2. In the checkout line: "Will the person give Mommy/Daddy any money back?" — Sample answer (after watching): "Yes!" or "No, it was exact." — Follow-up: "What coins do you see?"
3. At home with a piggy bank or jar: "Lets put the dimes in one pile and the pennies in another." — Follow-up: "Which pile is more money?"

Quarter 3 (Cashs Cafe / Classroom Stores)

1. After school: "What was your job at Cashs Cafe today?" — Follow-up: "Did you do it the way you were supposed to?"
2. Walking through a real cafe: "I see a helper. What do you think their job is?" — Follow-up: "Who pays who here?"
3. At home: "Lets play store. Im the customer; you be the helper." — Use real coins or pretend. — Follow-up: "What did you do well?"

Quarter 4 (Finishing a Job)

1. After they finish anything: "Did you finish that the way it was supposed to be done?" — Follow-up: "What would you do differently next time?"
2. On a walk: "Whats one helper-business we passed today?" — Follow-up: "What problem do they help with?"
3. Bedtime: "Whats one helper word you said today?" — Sample answers: "Please. Thank you. How can I help you?" — Follow-up: "Which one was hardest?"

Sensitivity reminder. None of these prompts ask about family money, family debts, or family banking. If your family runs a business, great. If you do not have one, also great. The conversation works either way.

CASH

Which people, and how do you know?

ROUND 2 PATCH — What Cash Never Says (Parent Reference)

Cash to Companys most distinctive brand promise is the language we dont use. We thought youd want to know.

Cash will never say to your child:

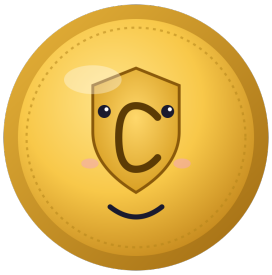
- "Amazing!" / "Awesome!" / "Crushing it!" — instead, Cash says "okay, thats specific — whats the evidence?"
- "Everyone can be rich" / "Anyone can be a millionaire" — Cash promises clearer thinking, not wealth.
- "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Financial freedom" — Cash names hard things directly.
- "Just believe in yourself" — as a substitute for evidence. Belief without evidence is what gets people in trouble.
- Anything that implies money problems are a personal failing.

Cash always asks instead:

- "Which people, and how do you know?"
- "What did they actually say?"
- "Whats the evidence?"

Why this matters at home. Your child is going to encounter financial-literacy content from many sources, including some that lean hustle-bro or get-rich-quick. The contrast is the point. Cash is on your familys side: clear-eyed, honest, and never selling.

One question to ask your child this year: "Did Cash ask you a question this week? What was it?" If your child can name one, the program is landing.



Which people, and how do you know?

— CASH

CASH TO COMPANY

Which people, and how do you know?

Cash is the friendly coin who helps us notice, ask, and try again. Cash will be with us all year. — Grade K